

Heuristic Evaluation

Structure of the individual report

Part I: Your Name

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Part II: Project Description

This project is a mobile app for artists to track their progress and get inspired. Key features include uploading drawings (using the camera or gallery), tagging artwork with categories like "Landscape" or "Portrait," and seeing a progress timeline with feedback. Users can also browse a filtered gallery of images to find inspiration.

Part III: Evaluation Execution

I evaluated the low-fidelity paper prototype of the "Drawing App" in a quiet setting. I walked through three main scenarios to test the design: 1) Uploading a drawing from the gallery; 2) Using filters to find inspiration; and 3) Checking the progress page. I looked at the screens and navigation logic to see if they followed Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics.

Part IV: List of Violations

1. H3 User control and freedom

- Where: Upload Flow - "Take a photo / Select from Gallery" Popup.
- What: The popup covers the screen, but there is no "Cancel" or "Close" (X) button visible.
- Why: If users tap this by mistake, they are stuck. They need a clear "emergency exit" to leave the popup without being forced to choose an option.
- Severity: 3

2. H4 Consistency and standards

- Where: General Navigation - Top Bar "Back" Buttons.
- What: The back button often has the name of the *current* page next to it (e.g., inside the Gallery, it says "< Gallery").
- Why: This is confusing. Standard apps usually label the back button with the *previous* page name (like "Home") so users know where they are going back to.
- Severity: 2

3. H3 User control and freedom

- Where: Progress Page - Feedback Prompt.
- What: The app asks "Do you want to receive feedback?" but only gives a "Yes" button.

- Why: Users should be able to say "No" or dismiss the message. Forcing them to click "Yes" takes away their control over the flow.
- Severity: 3

4. H1 Visibility of system status

- Where: Progress Page - Detailed Feedback Screen.
- What: The text gives feedback on "Drawings 1 and 2," but the screen only shows one image at a time.
- Why: It's hard to tell which drawing the text is referring to. The feedback should clearly match the image currently on the screen so users aren't confused.
- Severity: 2

5. H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use

- Where: Camera Interface (Take a photo screen).
- What: The camera screen is too simple and misses standard buttons like Flash, Switch Camera, or a Gallery shortcut.
- Why: Experienced users expect these standard tools to take better photos. Without them, the camera feels limited and less efficient.
- Severity: 2

Part V: Summary and Recommendations

Report in the table below the total number of identified violations.

Heuristic	# violations
H1: Visibility of system status	1
H2: Match between system and the real world	0
H3: User control and freedom	2
H4: Consistency and standards	1
H5: Error prevention	0
H6: Recognition rather than recall	0
H7: Flexibility and efficiency of use	1
H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design	0
H9: Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors	0

H10: Help and documentation	0
HN: Non-heuristic issue	0

General Impressions: Overall, the "Drawing App" has a fun concept, and the mascot adds a nice personality to the interface. The main tasks, like uploading and finding inspiration, are easy to figure out. However, I noticed some issues with navigation and control. The biggest problem is that popups often "trap" the user because they lack a clear exit button.

To improve this, I recommend adding a consistent "Close" (X) button to all menus and popups. Also, the navigation bar needs fixing: the "Back" button should show where the user is going (e.g., "Back to Home") instead of repeating the page title. Finally, the progress feedback would be much clearer if the text updated dynamically to match the specific drawing the user is looking at.